

TC004 / Top500 rank 4

Reflective Listening

Phase 5 Batch 1 v24 - full standalone TC001-grade Top500 technique package

Core move

Listen for the point underneath the words, reflect it briefly in your own plain language, and let them confirm, correct or deepen it.

Formula

Hear words -> identify core meaning or feeling -> reflect briefly -> pause for correction -> proceed

Calibration cue

They say "exactly" or elaborate They correct a small detail, which improves shared accuracy Their tone softens They move from defending to explaining If the person gives shorter answers, looks tense or corrects the frame, lower intensity immediately.

Minimum viable move

Use one sentence: "So the main thing is..." or "It sounds like the frustrating part was..."

Failure mode

The main failure mode is sounding like a therapist, repeating words mechanically, or reflecting so much that the conversation stops moving.

Field tip

Reflect the point under the words, not every word.